

Philipp Hilbert. *Lead Product Manager, client-side delivery and AI-native product work.*

Positioning, 13 years owning discovery-to-delivery for regulated and complex products, now doing that inside a consulting model.

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Dear Monks team,

I have spent 13 years owning product problems in regulated, high-stakes environments: defence AI at Rohde & Schwarz, national labour-market analytics for the German Federal Employment Agency, B2B insurance SaaS at EMIL Group, and clinical mobile apps. In every case, the hardest part was not writing the roadmap. It was earning enough trust from the client to tell them the honest answer instead of the comfortable one.

That is the job you are describing. The Lead Product Manager role at Monks sits between the client and the delivery team, and the person in that seat has to hold both at once. I know what it costs to get that balance wrong. At EMIL Group, I inherited a delivery organisation where client trust had broken down and senior engineers were leaving. I restructured three lean teams with their own leads, shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week. The fix was not process. It was being clear about what we were actually building and why.

On AI tools: I use Claude Code and Copilot as daily instruments for spec work, in-repo refactors, and edge-case generation. I have built multi-agent workflows in n8n and prototyped front-ends with Lovable and Framer. I am not fluent in these tools as a talking point. I use them to move faster on the discovery and scoping work that usually takes the longest.

The Monks.Flow angle is the part of this role I find most interesting. Helping a client instrument their marketing stack with agentic orchestration is a hard product problem: you have to understand their operational workflow deeply enough to know where an agent loop adds value and where it just adds complexity. That kind of discovery and requirements work is what I do.

I would welcome a conversation about how this fits the team's current pipeline.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
